

Assessment Brief: Individual Coursework 2024–25

Assessment Details

Course Title:	Information Presentation and Visualisation
Course Code:	LDSCI5209
Course Leader:	Dimitris Mylonas
Level:	5
First, Second, or Third Sitting:	First and Second
Assessment Title:	Explorable Visual Data Stories
Assessment Number:	AE2
Assessment Type:	Written Assignment
Restrictions on Time/Length:	2500 words
Assessment Weighting:	40%
Issue Date:	08 January 2025
Hand-in Deadline:	03 April 2025, 13:00
Planned Feedback Deadline:	28 calendar days after hand-in deadline
Mode of Submission:	Online (Canvas)
Anonymous Submission:	Yes

Assessment Task

This assignment challenges you to create an explorable article that uses data visualisation to explain a complex subject to a general audience. Think of it like a digital storybook where the reader can explore the data to learn more.

1. Choose your story

You will find a real dataset of your choice, ideally with substantial depth, and apply the data visualisation principles learned throughout the course to design effective information presentations. The topic may span a range of fields such as scientific phenomena, machine learning algorithms, social networks, or any area of personal

interest. Talk to your instructors if you have any questions or need guidance with your project. **Note:** If you are re-taking this assignment in a second sitting, you must select a different dataset and develop a new data story.

2. Build your story

Your task is to tell a compelling data story by combining clear written explanations with engaging visualisations for the reader to explore. You are encouraged to draw inspiration from examples highlighted in the slides and web galleries such as [Explorables](#) and [Idyll](#). While the writing should be substantial, your visualisations and interactivity should take centre stage to adhere to best practices discussed in class unless justified otherwise. The project should demonstrate mature visual and interaction design, showcasing iterative improvement and minimal usability issues by incorporating user feedback. You must provide enough text, narration, and annotation to fully tell your data story, applying the storytelling principles discussed in class.

3. Technical aspects of your story

Use Python-based tools such as Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly, Bokeh, or Dash to create the visual elements. You can find examples of interactive notebooks here: <https://jupyterbook.org/en/stable/interactive/interactive.html>. The final submission will be an HTML export of a Jupyter or Colab notebook, featuring both the written content in styled markdown and the visualisations.

Your work will be assessed on the quality of the data selection and preparation, the effectiveness and creativity of the visualisations, usability and user experience, storytelling, and overall presentation and language proficiency.

#	Task	Mark
1	Data Selection and Preparation	20
2	Visualisations	40
3	User experience	10
4	Storytelling	10
5	Presentation and English Language Proficiency	20
		100

Assessment Criteria

The assessment covers all topics up to and including week 6. The generic assessment criteria are listed below.

70 or higher	There was evidence of the ability to perform all tasks correctly. The demonstration of the methods was excellent, coherent, well documented, and clearly explained.
60-69	There was evidence of ability to perform some tasks correctly. The demonstration of the methods is good, coherent, and reasonably detailed and explained.
50-59	There was evidence of ability to perform some tasks correctly, but the demonstration of the methods was limited, incoherent, not adequately documented and vaguely explained.
40-49	There was limited evidence of ability to perform tasks. The demonstration of the methods involved significant omissions and produced substantial inaccuracies.
39 or less	Failure to solve the tasks in the assignment. Methods were completely incorrect or absent.

Submitting Assessments

You have three submission attempts, but only the last submission will be graded. If your last submission attempt is late, you will receive the late penalty even if you have a previous submission that was on time. Please make sure to avoid multiple submissions for assessments with multiple components, as only the last attempt will be graded. Upload several files in one submission attempt instead.

If your assessment requires anonymous submission (see the assessment details table at the top of your assessment brief), please be sure you have left your name off of your submission and out of the submission file name, as failing to do so may result in a 0% mark on the assessment.

Refer to the assessment details table in your assignment brief for acceptable file formats. Avoid submitting zip files (unless explicitly required by the assessment brief); use the 'add files' function to submit multiple files instead. If you are submitting a physical artefact, you must also provide clear and thorough documentation (such

as in the form of photographs or a video) of your submission by the deadline; see the bottom of this section for guidance on submitting video files.

Please ensure that you tick the agreement box at the very bottom of your Canvas submission page (scroll down if you don't see it). This will enable you to select 'Submit Assessment.' Please review the submitted file to ensure that everything is in order.

If you encounter any issues with submission, e-mail a copy of your assignment before the deadline to student.assessments@nulondon.ac.uk along with screenshots of the problem on Canvas, showing a timestamp.

To turn on notifications for submission confirmation emails in your Canvas settings: Account > Notifications > Turn on the bell for 'All submissions.' In the app this is via Settings > Email Notifications > All submissions.

To submit a video recording: Select the 'Panopto video' icon in the text entry box in your submission portal. You can upload a video file of any format from your media library by selecting 'upload,' choosing 'my folder' in the drop down menu, and clicking 'insert.' You should be able to play the video back once it processes. See further explanation, including guidance on recording videos using Panopto, in this support article: [How to Submit a Video Assignment in Canvas.](#)

Marking

The University uses two categorical assessment marking schemes – one for undergraduate and one for postgraduate – to mark all taught programmes leading to an award of the University.

More detailed information on the categorical assessment marking scheme and the criteria can be found in the Course Syllabus, available on the University's VLE.

Learning Outcomes

This assessment should enable students to demonstrate in full or in part the learning outcomes identified in the Course Descriptor. On successful completion of the course, students will be able to:

Knowledge and Understanding

- K1b Demonstrate knowledge and critical understanding of well-established concepts in information design and data visualisation techniques.
- K2b Demonstrate knowledge of human perception and cognition to assess the quality and effectiveness of a data visualisation.

- K3b Demonstrate the ability to identify the appropriate data visualisation techniques for exploration and discovery.

Subject Specific Skills

- S1b Apply data visualisation techniques in an appropriate manner to a given data set across application domains.
- S2b Develop a static or interactive reproducible data visualisation in Python.
- S3b Design an effective data visualisation using human perception and cognition principles.

Transferable and Employability Skills

- T1b Constructively critique and assess a data visualisation.
- T3b Demonstrate a sound technical proficiency in written English and skill in selecting vocabulary so as to communicate effectively to specialist and non-specialist audiences.

Accessing Feedback

Students can expect to receive feedback on all summative coursework within 28 calendar days of the submission deadline or, if applicable, the last oral assessment date, whichever later. The 28 calendar day deadline does not apply to work submitted late. Feedback can be accessed through the assessment link on the Canvas course page.

Late Submissions

Please ensure that you submit your assignment well before the deadline to avoid any late penalties, as a submission made exactly on the deadline will be considered late. Please keep in mind that there may be differences between your computer's clock and the server time, which can cause discrepancies, and that Canvas may take some time to process your submission.

Your Canvas submission portal displays two due dates: one is the deadline for your assignment, and the second is the latest possible date by which your assignment can be submitted late. Please make sure you submit by the assessment deadline in order to avoid late penalties.

If assessments are submitted late without approved Extenuating Circumstances, there are penalties:

- For assessment elements submitted up to one day late, any passing mark will receive 10 marks deducted or a threshold pass (40% for undergraduate students, 50% for postgraduate students), whichever is higher. Any mark

below 40% for undergraduate students and below 50% for postgraduate students will stand.

- Students who do not submit their assessment within one day of the deadline, and have no approved Extenuating Circumstances, are deemed not to have submitted and to have failed that assessment element. The mark recorded will be 0%.
- For assessment subelements, late submission will result in non-submission penalties deducted according to the marking criteria above.

For further information, please refer to [AQF7 Part C in the Academic Handbook](#).

Extenuating Circumstances

The University's Extenuating Circumstances (ECs) procedure is in place if there are genuine circumstances that may prevent a student from submitting an assessment. If the EC application is successful, there will be no academic penalty for missing the published submission deadline.

Students are normally expected to apply for ECs in advance of the assessment deadline. Students may apply for consideration of ECs retrospectively if they can provide evidence that they could not have done so in advance of the deadline. All applications for ECs must be supported by independent evidence.

Successful EC applications for live oral assessments, including vivas, will result in a deferral of the oral to be organized by faculty, students, and Timetabling for a date as close as possible to the original presentation date. The deadline for supplementary materials, if assigned, will be carried forward by the length of the oral assessment extension.

Missing an oral assessment, including a compulsory viva, without an approved EC will result in a non-submission for the entire assessment and, accordingly, a recorded mark of 0%.

Students are reminded that the ECs procedure covers only short-term issues (within 21 days leading to the submission deadline) and that if they experience longer-term matters that impact on learning then they must contact [Student Support and Development](#) for advice.

Under the Extenuating Circumstances Policy, students may defer an assessed element on only one occasion and may request an extension on a maximum of two occasions.

For further information, please refer to the [Extenuating Circumstances Policy](#) in the Academic Handbook.

Academic Misconduct

Any submission must be a student's own work and, where facts or ideas have been used from other sources, these sources must be appropriately referenced. The

University reserves the right to hold a viva if there are concerns about the authenticity of a student's or learner's work. The Academic Misconduct Policy includes the definitions of all practices that will be deemed to constitute academic misconduct. This includes the use of artificial intelligence (AI) where not expressly permitted within the assessment brief, or in a manner other than specified. Students should check this policy before submitting their work. Students suspected of committing Academic Misconduct will face action under the Policy. Where students are found to have committed an offence they will be subject to sanction, which may include failing an assessment, failing a course or being dismissed from the University depending upon the severity of the offence committed. For further information, please refer to the [Academic Misconduct Policy](#) in the Academic Handbook.

Version History

Title: Assessment Brief Template					
Approved by: The Quality Team					
Version number	Date approved	Date published	Owner	Location	Proposed next review date
4.0	March 2023	March 2023	Registrar	VLE/ Faculty Resource s Page	March 2024
3.0	August 2022	August 2022	Registrar	VLE, Faculty Resource s Page	July 2023
2.3	December 2021	December 2021	Registrar	VLE	August 2022
2.2	August 2021	August 2021	Registrar	VLE	August 2022
2.1	September 2020	September 2020	Registrar	VLE	August 2021
2.0	September 2020	September 2020	Registrar	VLE	August 2021
1.0	August 2019	August 2019	Registrar	VLE	August 2020
Referenced documents	AQF7 Academic Regulations for Taught Awards; Extenuating Circumstances Policy; Academic Misconduct Policy; Course Syllabus				

External Reference Point(s)	UK Quality Code Theme: Assessment
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